PRODUCT / PRACTICE / PLAY

Ben Whitfield-Heap

Product leader / builder

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CURRENTLY Head of Product at Kahootz / February 2025 to present

PROFILE

A product leader for the messy middle

Product leader with 17 years' experience across B2B SaaS, public-sector, healthtech, and tech-for-good environments. I shape product strategy, lead discovery, build evidence-led operating models, and help teams align around measurable outcomes. Currently Head of Product at Kahootz, combining product leadership with hands-on delivery, analytics, enterprise assurance, and practical AI integration.

SELECTED WORK

Things I have built, shaped, and kept curious

Status is part of the description. Product Mole is live and in use at Kahootz.

PROJECT / STATUS	WHAT IT IS / LINKS
Product Mole LIVE / IN USE Kahootz AI / product work	A local-first context system for product managers and AI assistants. Live and in use at Kahootz as part of my AI and product work. GitHub repo
Wolds Record LIVE SAAS AI-built SaaS	The live Wolds Record app, a SaaS product I built solo with AI. Open app
The Guide EXPERIMENT AI / interactive story	A mobile-first AI adventure experience. GitHub repo
Effective Salary Calculator LIVE TOOL Utility / decision aid	A simple tool for comparing the value of a total salary remuneration package. Live tool · GitHub repo
BWH Agent Toolkit PUBLIC TOOLKIT Open-source agent skills	A portable collection of agent skills for product discovery, specification, software delivery, engineering analysis, verification, and technical writing. GitHub repo
BenOS PUBLIC PROJECT Local-first micro-apps	A local-first collection of tiny personal micro-apps. Browser-only tools with no accounts, sync, or cloud. Open BenOS · GitHub repo

PROJECT / STATUS	WHAT IT IS / LINKS
Playful experiments INTERACTIVE Games / interfaces	The point-and-click puzzle story behind simplyben.co.uk, plus small browser games such as Dodge Balls. Site repo · Dodge Balls

EXPERIENCE

Product leadership across SaaS and public services

Strategy, discovery, delivery, analytics, and the systems that help teams make better decisions.

Kahootz / Head of Product

February 2025 to present

Secure B2B collaboration SaaS platform

- Introduced clearer ownership of roadmap, prioritisation, and product decision-making across the organisation.
- Introduced a development portfolio and reporting model across product development, internal work, client-facing work, support, and bug fixing.
- Product Mole is live and in use at Kahootz as part of my AI and product work.
- Oversee support and security alongside product, including ISMS management and ISO 27001 and Cyber Essentials compliance.
- Member of the Senior Leadership Team, contributing to company-level priorities beyond product.

Methods / Senior Product Manager

May 2024 to January 2025

Digital agency specialising in public-sector innovation

- Led the Department for Transport Respond transformation, creating a three-year roadmap toward automation and identifying AI-powered opportunities for policy drafting, testing, and insight.
- Managed a multidisciplinary team of five across product, design, and research, and introduced engagement and satisfaction baselines using Azure Application Insights.
- Extended the initial commission from two to nine months by building client confidence through actionable insight and securing additional design resource.

dxw / Senior Product Manager

February 2023 to May 2024

Employee-owned digital agency building technology for good

- Digitised the Ministry of Justice Community Accommodation Tier 2 service from 0 to 1, increasing applications by over 100%, reducing digital consent capture from hours to minutes, and integrating with internal MoJ systems.
- Established product strategy and reporting baselines across legal, information governance, and third-party suppliers.

EXPERIENCE / CONTINUED

NHS England

NHS England / Senior Product Manager

October 2016 to February 2023

NHS Futures (formerly FutureNHS) collaboration platform and Local Health and Care Records programme

- Scaled the FutureNHS collaboration service, now NHS Futures, from 8,000 to more than 50,000 monthly active users in three years by defining product vision and growth strategy for an enterprise collaboration service used across the health and care sector.
- Changed the registration process and reduced registration support tickets by 50%; supported a service desk handling 2,500+ tickets per month with a 15-minute average first reply and 90% satisfaction.
- Secured £1.5m investment for an NHS-owned open-source collaboration platform and led roadmap, discovery, and external suppliers through service assessment to private beta.
- Established an online community of more than 200 digital leaders and created an interactive maturity map used by NHS England's CIO.

EARLIER CAREER

A foundation in delivery and systems

Senior Project Manager, Attercopia (2015 to 2016); Digital Project Manager, CDS / Bailie Group (2014 to 2015); Project Manager, Capita Customer Management (2013 to 2014); Systems Project Manager, StepChange Debt Charity (2011 to 2013); Project Analyst, Wm Morrison Supermarkets (2011); Junior Project Manager, Child Maintenance Commission (2009 to 2011).

QUALIFICATIONS AND TOOLS

The useful specifics

QUALIFICATIONS Professional Scrum Product Owner I · AgilePM Practitioner · ITIL Foundation · MSP Practitioner · PRINCE2 Practitioner · BSc (Hons) Business Administration, University of Bath

TOOLS AND METHODS Product discovery, product strategy, roadmapping, product operations, agile delivery, service design, accessibility, outcome measurement, Jira, Azure DevOps, Azure Application Insights, Google Analytics, Tag Manager, Looker Studio, Power BI, Tableau, GitHub, GitHub Copilot, Slack, Zendesk, Google Workspace, and Microsoft 365.